

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What's happening to me ... ?



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever had a strange experience? What happened?
- How do you feel about hospitals? Do they give you the creeps?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about coincidences, strange events, and superstitions.
- I can talk about life experiences.
- I can talk about what was happening when something else happened.





Let's Explore!

Let's read a story about a **strange event*** ... What do you think happened to Maria?

* A "strange event" can be related to a mystery or a superstition.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Maria was woken up by the fluorescent lights of the hospital room. She'd been admitted to the hospital the day before, to undergo surgery on her knee. But now, there was a terrible pain in her stomach, and Maria just didn't feel like herself. Just as she was beginning to become more aware of her surroundings, a nurse bustled into the room.

She was greeted by the nurse. "Ah, Mrs. Green, I see you're awake!" she said.

Her voice was shaking as she said "Mrs. Green? I'm not Mrs. Green ..."

"Yes, you are," the nurse said. "It's here on your chart. Isabella Green, gall bladder operation. You must be confused from the anesthetic."

When the nurse left, Maria looked down at her stomach and saw the stitches across her belly. But, this was not her stomach. Maria touched her face. "This is the face and body of an old woman." Maria thought, as she felt the panic rise in her chest. She had noticed an old man in the room who was cleaning the floor.

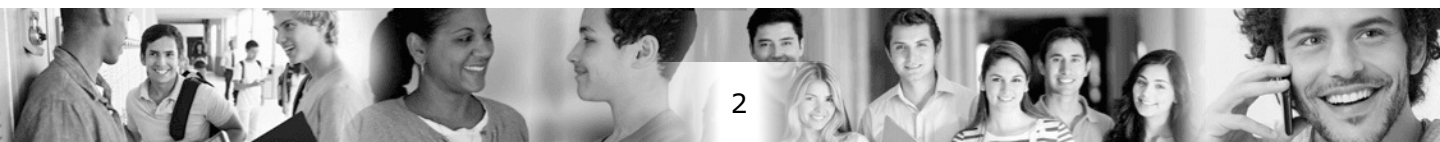
"What's wrong?" the man asked.

"This is not me. I'm a young woman, not an old lady. I had come in yesterday for surgery and woke up like, like ..."

The old man looked at her wisely. "I have a powder I keep with me for emergencies like these. When it is mixed with water, it becomes a potion. When you wake up, you'll be back to yourself."

She thanked him and drank it down.

To be continued ...





Let's Practice!

Maria is in the hospital trying to understand what happened.

Instructions: Match a half from the left with one from the right to complete each sentence coherently. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|--|
| 1. When she woke up, she realized | () had happened to her. |
| 2. She remembered a nurse | () before the man spoke to the lady. |
| 3. The nurse told | () she had undergone surgery. |
| 4. Two hours had passed | () had admitted her to the hospital the day before. |
| 5. She couldn't remember what | () the woman she had spent all night in intensive care. |



Let's Practice!

Maria wants to feel like herself soon.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete them with the words that correspond coherently.

Word Bank

was removed / was operated on / was woken up / was greeted / been admitted / was given

- Maria _____ by the fluorescent lights of the hospital room.
- She'd _____ to the hospital the day before.
- She _____ by the nurse.
- A magical potion _____ to her.
- She _____ and her gall bladder _____.





Extension Activity

Tell a story about a hospital visit.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Tell a friend about a visit to the hospital in the past.
- Describe the events and explain how you felt about it.
- Write a description of 100 words explaining what happened.
- Use the passive, past perfect and past continuous to tell the story.
- Read your story in a group and correct any errors.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I tell a friend about a hospital visit in the past.

☐ ☐

I write a 100-word description about a hospital visit in the past.

☐ ☐

I use passive form, past perfect, simple past and past continuous.

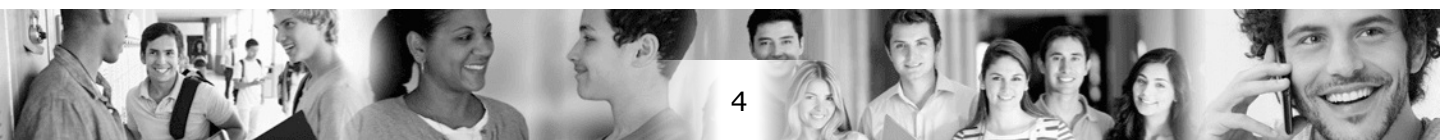
☐ ☐

I read my story aloud and correct any errors I find.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- fluorescent** (adjective): bright and glowing
e.g. María was woken up by the fluorescent lights of the hospital room.
- to undergo** (verb): to experience something that is unpleasant or involves a change
e.g. She'd been admitted to the hospital the day before, to undergo surgery on her knee.
- to feel like yourself** (expression): to feel in good health or temper as usual
e.g. There was a terrible pain in her stomach, and María just didn't feel like herself.
- surroundings** (noun): the area and things around you
e.g. She was beginning to become more aware of her surroundings.
- to bustle** (verb): to move or behave looking busy or in a hurry
e.g. A nurse bustled into the room.
- gall bladder** (noun): an organ in the body that stores bile
e.g. It's here on your chart. Isabella Green, gall bladder operation.
- anesthetic** (noun): a drug that blocks the pain someone is feeling
e.g. You must be confused from the anesthetic.
- stitches** (noun): a kind of thread used to keep an open wound closed
e.g. María looked down at her stomach and saw the stitches across her belly.
- panic** (noun): a sudden feeling of being nervous and frightened
e.g. María felt the panic rise in her chest when she saw the face of an old woman.
- potion** (noun): a drink that is supposed to have magic properties, good or bad
e.g. When it is mixed with water, it becomes a potion.





Learning Points

The Passive

You use an active structure when you want the 'doer' of the action to be the subject.
You use a passive structure when you want the 'receiver' of the action to be the subject.

Active sentence = When you (subject) mix the powder (object) with water, it becomes a potion.

Passive sentence = When the powder (subject) **is mixed** with water, it becomes a potion.

It is not necessary to mention the object from an active sentence when it is changed to a passive sentence.

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of the *be* verb followed by the past participle.

The Simple Present passive form is:

am/are/is + past participle

For example:

*Patients **are greeted** when they wake up from surgery.*

The Simple Past passive form is:

was/were + past participle

For example:

*María **was woken up** by the fluorescent lights of the hospital room.*

Examples:

- *She was greeted by the nurse.*
- *When it is mixed with water, it becomes a potion.*

The Past Perfect, Simple Past and Past Continuous Tenses

You use the **Past Perfect** tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

You use the **Past Continuous** tense to talk about an action that was happening at a time before now.

You use the **Simple Past** to talk about a finished action that happened at a specific time in the past.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time than the past event by using the **Past Perfect** tense.





Learning Points

The structure of the **Past Perfect** is:

Subject + had + past participle

*When I arrived at the party, Vanessa **had** already **gone** home.*

Which event happened first? Vanessa went home.

Which event happened later? I arrived at the party.

You use the **Past Perfect** tense (not **Past Simple**) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

You can use the **Past Continuous** to:

- describe the background in a story written in the past tense

For example:

*The children **were laughing** and the birds **were singing** in the park. A woman **was looking** for her phone, which she dropped somewhere ...*

- to describe an action that was interrupted by another event or action in the past

For example:

*I **was reading** the news the other day **when I came across** an article that talked about a trial by judge.*

The form of the **Past Continuous** is:

Subject + was/were + verb-ing

Examples:

- *She'd been admitted to the hospital the day before.*
- *She had noticed an old man in the room who was cleaning the floor.*
- *I had come in yesterday for surgery and woke up.*
- *Just as she was beginning to become more aware of her surroundings, a nurse bustled into the room.*
- *María touched her face.*
- *She thanked him and drank it down.*

